cauce

Free Guide | First Issue | Foreign Investors

Buying property in Venezuela as a foreigner:

steps, costs and risks

This guide is for information only. It is not legal, tax or investment advice. For your transaction you need a Venezuelan lawyer.

BEFORE SENDING MONEY / SANCTIONS

US and other governments maintain Venezuela-related sanctions. Have a lawyer in your own country check the parties, banks and payment route before sending money. Cauce does not assess compliance. OFAC.

STEP 1

Can you own property?

Yes, in principle. Civil Code Article 26 grants foreigners civil rights subject to exceptions; Article 10 applies Venezuelan law to local property. Legal capacity means being able to enter a binding transaction.

Cauce's take · opinion. Before a deposit, have your lawyer confirm registry acceptance of your identity, immigration status and signing authority. **[VERIFY]** your visa requirement.

Source: Civil Code, arts. 10 and 26 (OAS copy).

STEP 2

Which visa fits?

Validity and permitted stay differ. Buying a home does not itself qualify you for TR-I or residency.

TR-I · Investor. 3 years / stay within validity. Productive investment accepted by authorities; not a residential purchase.

TR-N · Business. 1 year. **[VERIFY]** stay: 180 days (Madrid), 90 (France). Business evidence.

TR-E/I · Business owner. 2 years / 4 months per entry. Company ownership and related travel.

TR-FV · Venezuelan family. 1 year / stay within validity. Eligible family relationship and intent to settle.

TR-RE · Income / pension. 1 year / same stay. Proven lawful passive income from abroad.

TR-L · Employment. 1 year / same stay. Employer sponsorship and work authorization.

Sources: each visa row links to its consular page. Reconfirm your requirements and residency route.

STEP 3

Prepare from abroad

US applicants: official US guidance links to Cancillería Digital for e-visas, including tourist (T) and business (TR-N).

TR-I is separate. MPPRE, Venezuela's foreign ministry, publishes investor requirements. **[VERIFY]** US-based filing, consular jurisdiction and prior approvals; no current US consular TR-I intake notice was verified.

Confirm appointment or submission procedure, passport, application, photos, financial and category evidence, certificates, fees and timing.

An **apostille** authenticates a public document under the Hague Convention. Otherwise, consular legalization may be needed. Confirm Spanish translations.

Sources: US State Department · US Embassy · MPPRE TR-I · Venezuelan Embassy: TR-I · HCCH.

STEP 4

Get your tax ID

RIF is the tax ID issued by **SENIAT**, Venezuela's tax authority. Start through SENIAT; prepare passport, address and immigration evidence. A **cédula** is a Venezuelan identity card.

The August 2026 reform removed periodic expiry; update changed details. **[VERIFY]** passport-only registration and any in-person validation.

Source: G.O. 43.435 / SNAT/2026/00080 via Baker McKenzie; verify primary text.

[VERIFY] flags a point for legal review. TR-I may extend for two years before a conditional residency application; confirm your route.

YOUR NOTES / VISA AND DOCUMENTS

Before the title is yours.

Check the property, the payment and the paperwork.

STEP 5

Check the title

SAREN is the registry and notary service. Complete its required foreign-buyer registration; the portal accepts passport or foreign cédula details.

Verify seller identity, title history, liens, inheritance, co-owner consent and occupancy. Match the deed, municipal record and premises. Obtain **solvencias**: tax and dues clearance certificates.

Stop signals: missing originals, unresolved inheritance, mismatched areas or payment to an unrelated person.

Source: SAREN portal. Checklist: Cauce; confirm with counsel.

STEP 6

Your closing checklist

- ☐ **Buyer file.** Passport, RIF, immigration status, SAREN confirmation and marital-status documents.
- ☐ **Property file.** Verified title, municipal record, solvencias, permissions and occupancy terms.
- ☐ **Signing file.** Reviewed deed, accepted power of attorney, translations and interpreter if required.
- ☐ **Money file.** Quoted fees, fiscal stamps (document taxes), tax allocation, bank route and proof of funds.
- ☐ **Completion file.** Agree funds release and handover; collect the registered deed and receipts.

Source: SAREN; transaction-specific checklist and charges require legal review.

Example closing costs: taxes & registry 3%; lawyer 1.5%; transfer 1%; notary & powers 0.5%; appraisal 0.3%. **Total example: 6.3%.** A 5%-8% example allowance needs local quotes; it is not a cap or an official rate.

STEP 7

Check the location

Special security zones can cover borders, coasts, islands and strategic sites. Check the exact parcel in **Margarita** before paying. **[VERIFY]** Defense Ministry permission and other buyer-specific restrictions; approval is not automatic.

Source: National Security Law, arts. 47-50, 58 (UNHCR).

Remote or in person?

Start abroad: appoint a lawyer and prepare documents. A **poder** (power of attorney) may allow local signing by a representative. Pre-clear wording and authentication.

Attendance: interviews, identity checks and executing the power may require it. **[VERIFY]** your visa route; do not rely on tourist-status conversion in Venezuela.

Source: Madrid: powers; confirm registry acceptance.

Two more questions

Venezuelan family? TR-FV may help if you qualify.
A local company? An alternative; structure and implications await legal review.

Source: Madrid TR-FV; company route [VERIFY].

The route to closing

Eligibility & payment → approvals → RIF, SAREN & title checks → signing & registration.

4-8 months: example only. No verified transaction sample; consular access, permissions or title defects may extend it.

YOUR NOTES / CLOSING

The Thursday newsletter

Free reporting on Caracas and Margarita.
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Discovery call

45-min call; visa path and checklist within 24 h. Fee credited toward "Title in your name" within 60 days.

Discovery call →

Cauce pairs sourced reporting with buying assistance. Services may involve fees or referral commissions; confirm terms before proceeding.